

Global CO₂ Emissions: Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

Fossil fuels & industry, 1750–2024

A data-forward overview for policy analysts, climate negotiators, and sustainability researchers.

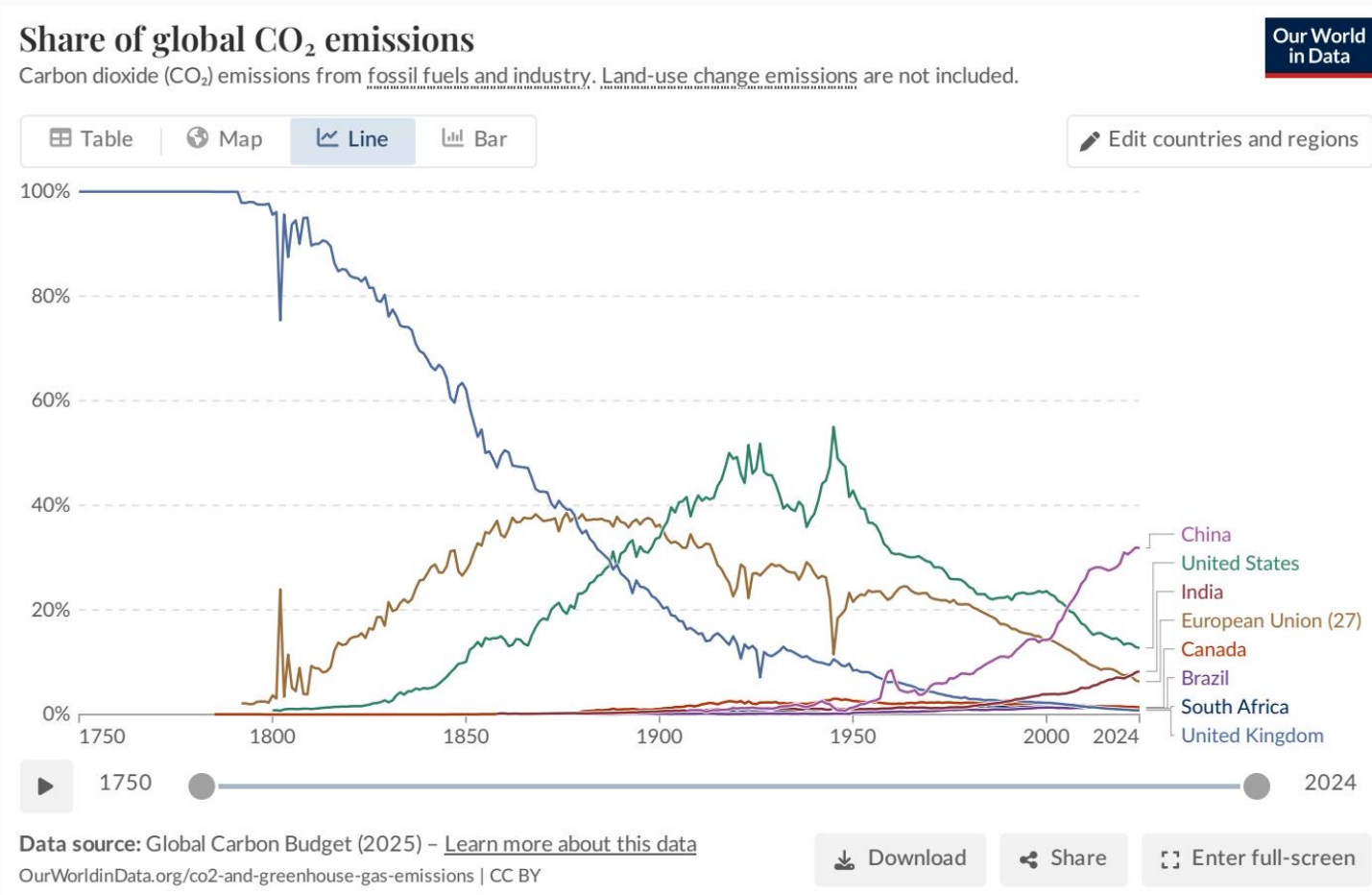
Data attribution

Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

Scope: territorial CO₂ emissions from fossil fuels and industry; land-use change noted where relevant.

Global CO₂ Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today

Long-run fossil-fuel and industry emissions: slow early growth, rapid post-1950 acceleration, recent slowing but no peak.



1750–2024

~6 Bt

Global CO₂ per year by 1950

>20 Bt

By 1990, nearly quadrupled from 1950

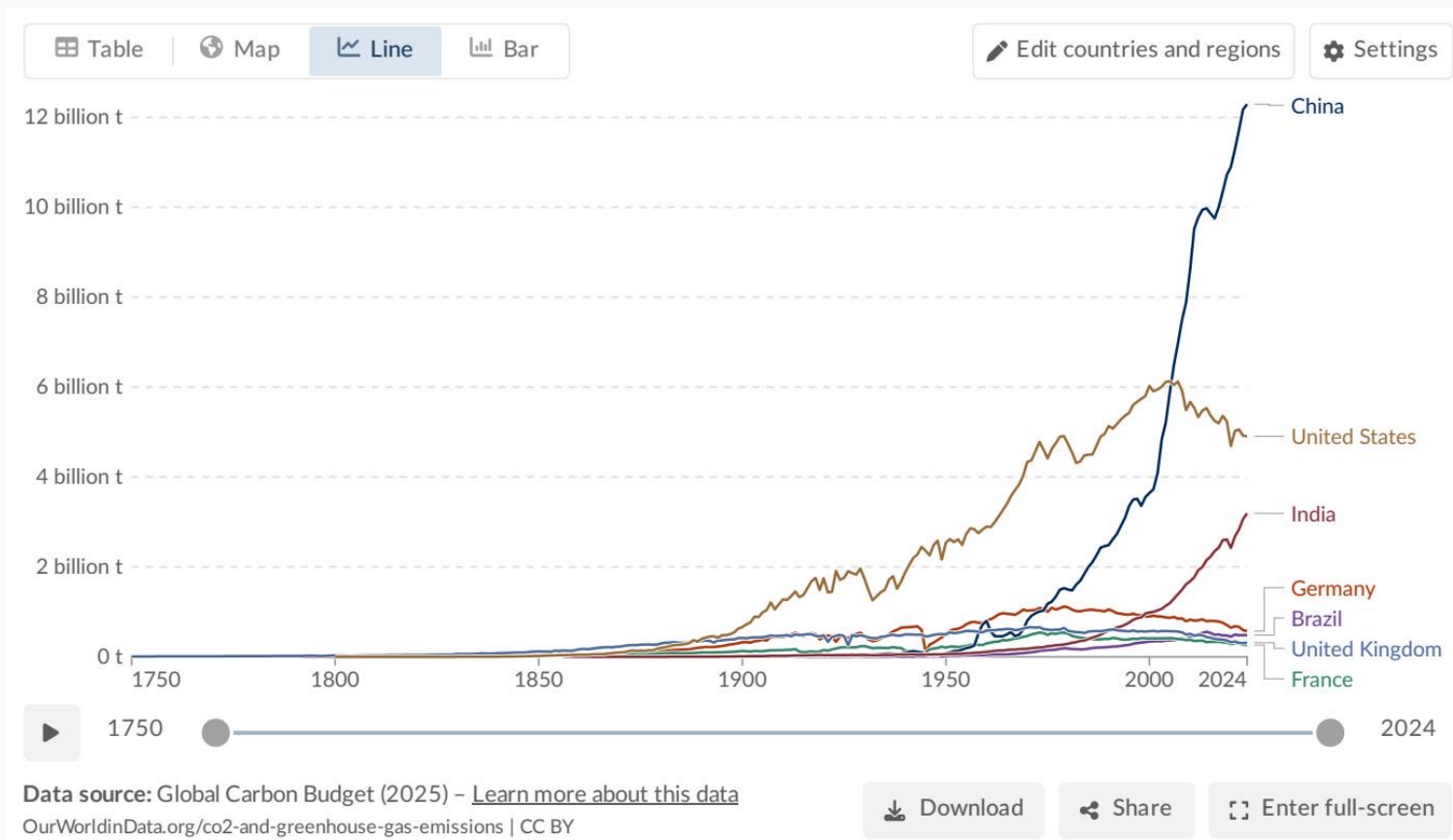
>35 Bt

Annual emissions today

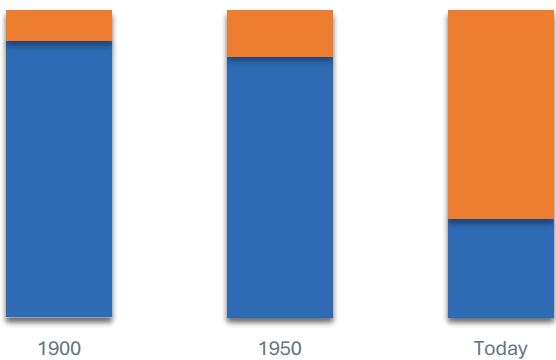
Growth has slowed, but emissions have not yet peaked.

Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third Today

Regional shares shifted as Asia — led by China — rose to roughly half of global emissions.



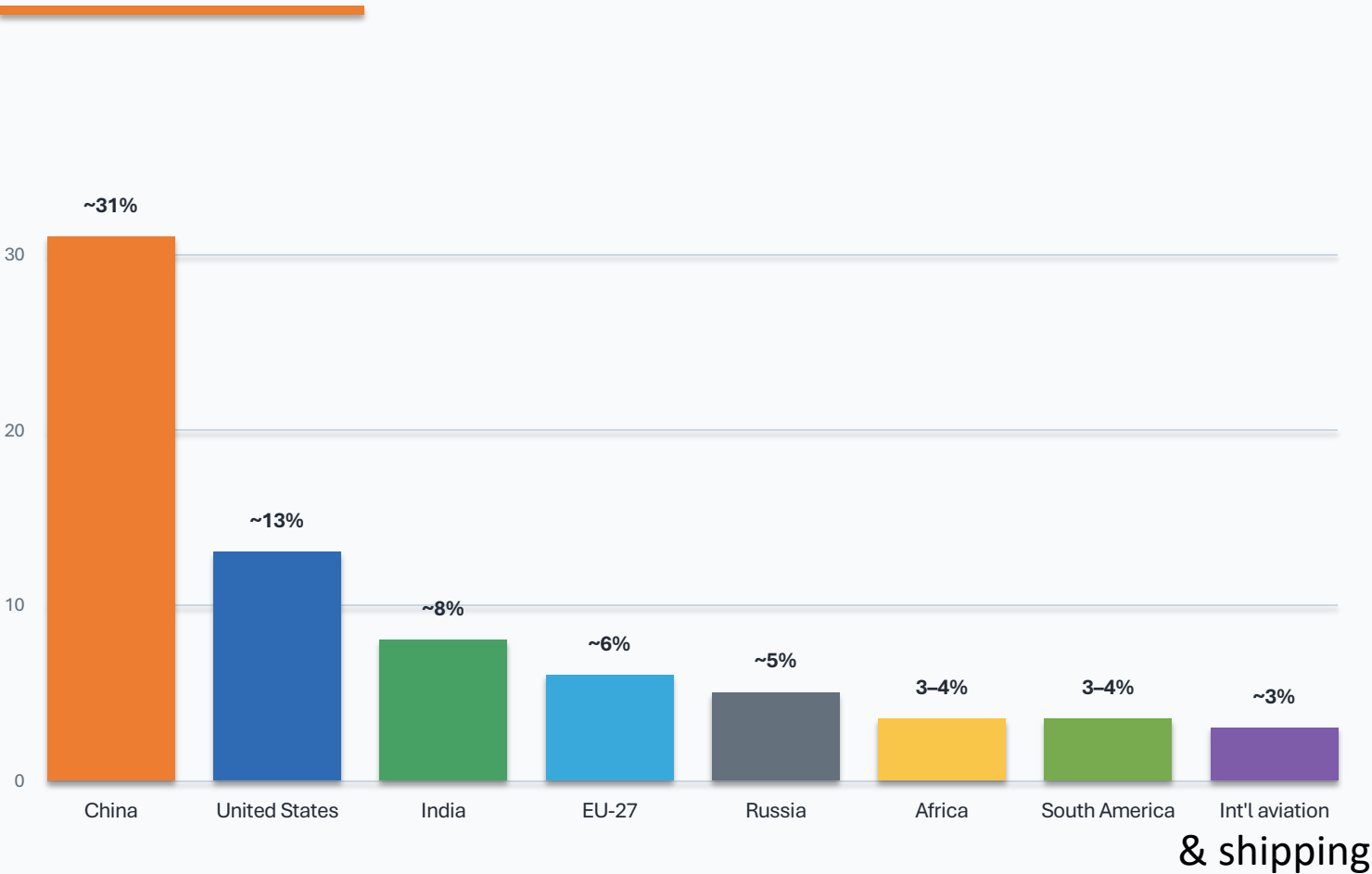
Share shift



- 1900: Europe and the US >90% of global CO₂
- 1950: still >85% of emissions
- Today: less than one-third
- Asia now produces roughly half

China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO₂

Country and region shares of global CO₂ emissions in 2024.



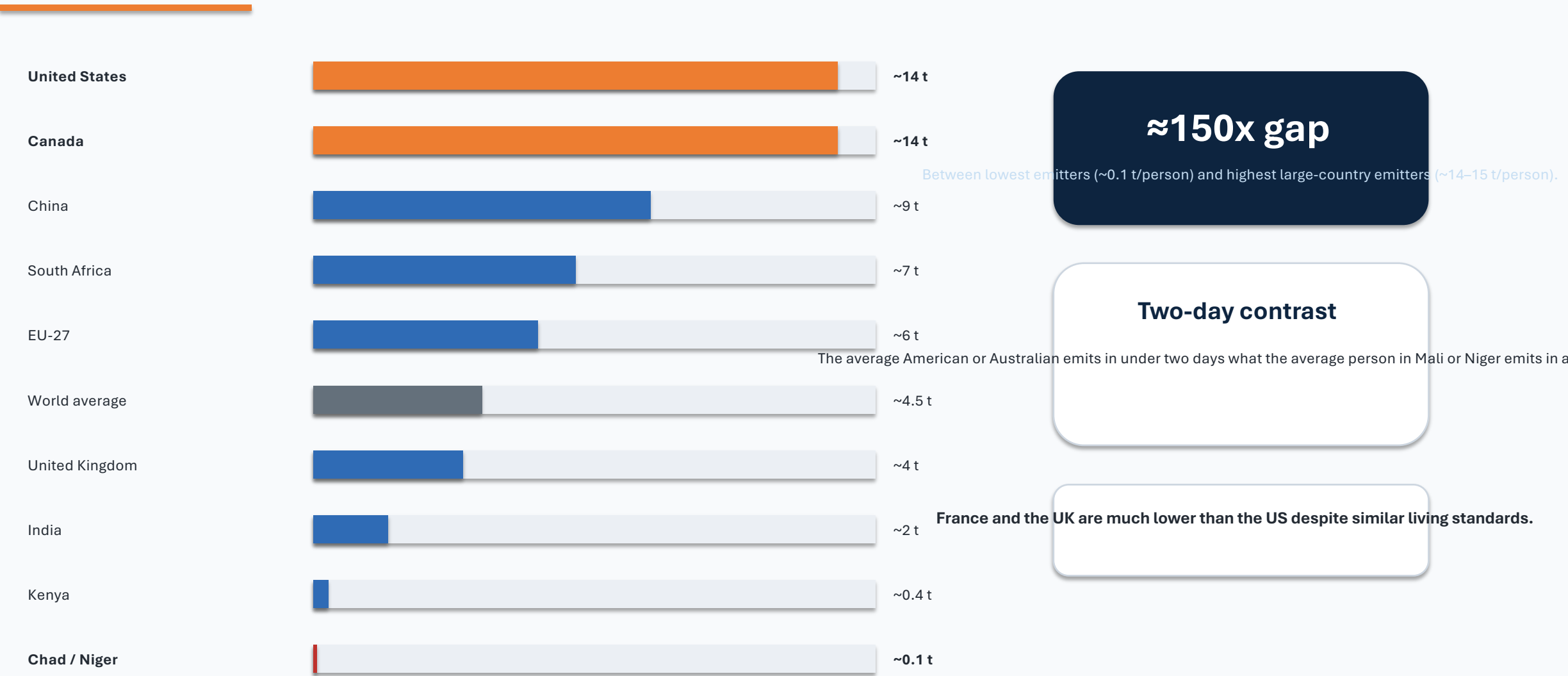
What changed?

- China accounts for ~31% — more than one-quarter.
- US share is ~13% and declining.
- India is ~8% and rising.
- EU-27 is ~6% and declining.
- Africa and South America each remain only 3-4%.

Trend labels from source table: China/India rising; US/EU declining; Russia and South Am

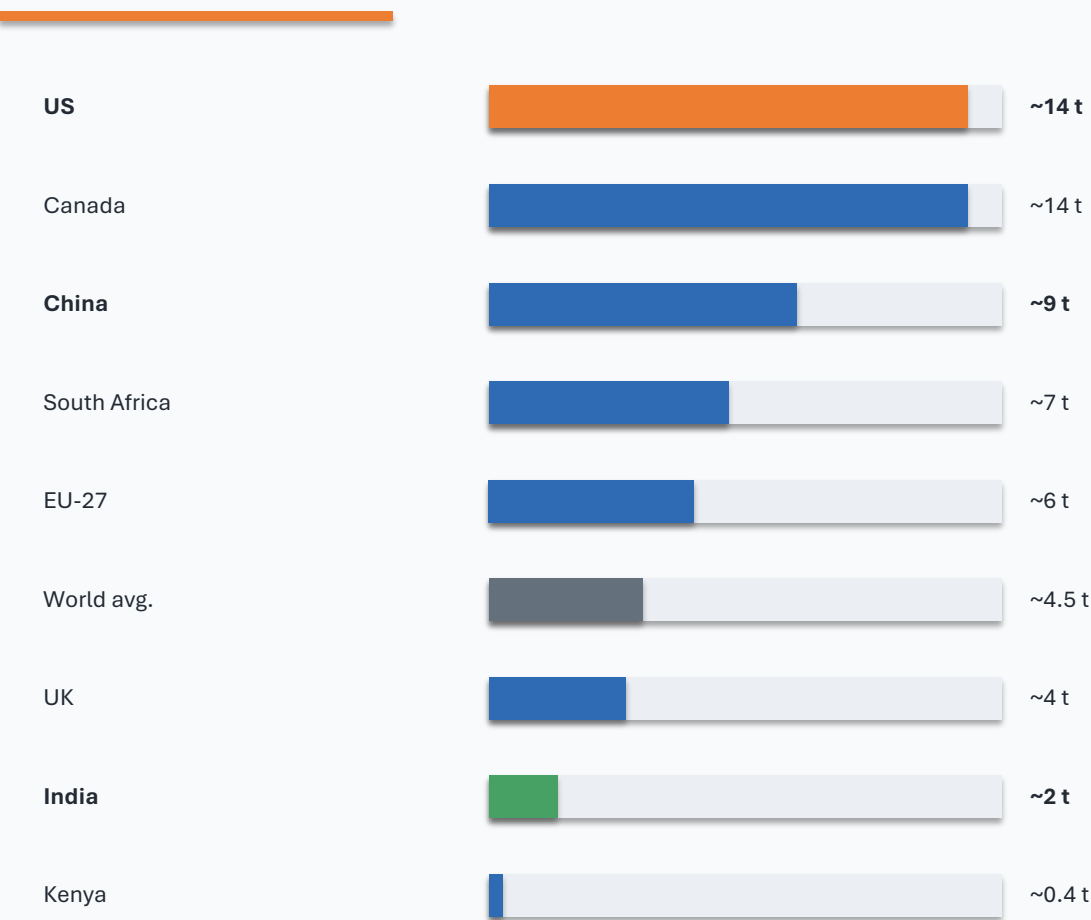
Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada

Per-person emissions reframe responsibility: low-emitting countries can be orders of magnitude below rich, high-emitting economies.

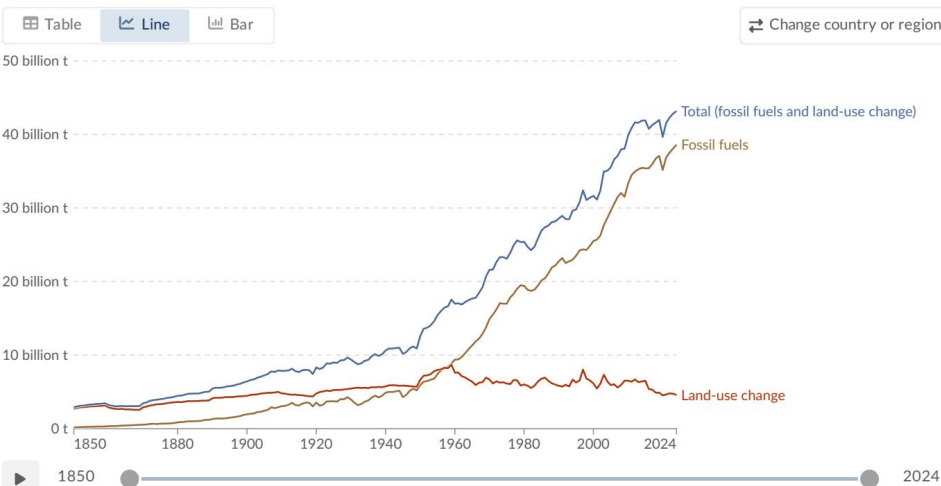


Per Capita Emissions Vary Widely: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India

China is the largest total emitter, but its per-capita emissions remain below the US; India remains low.



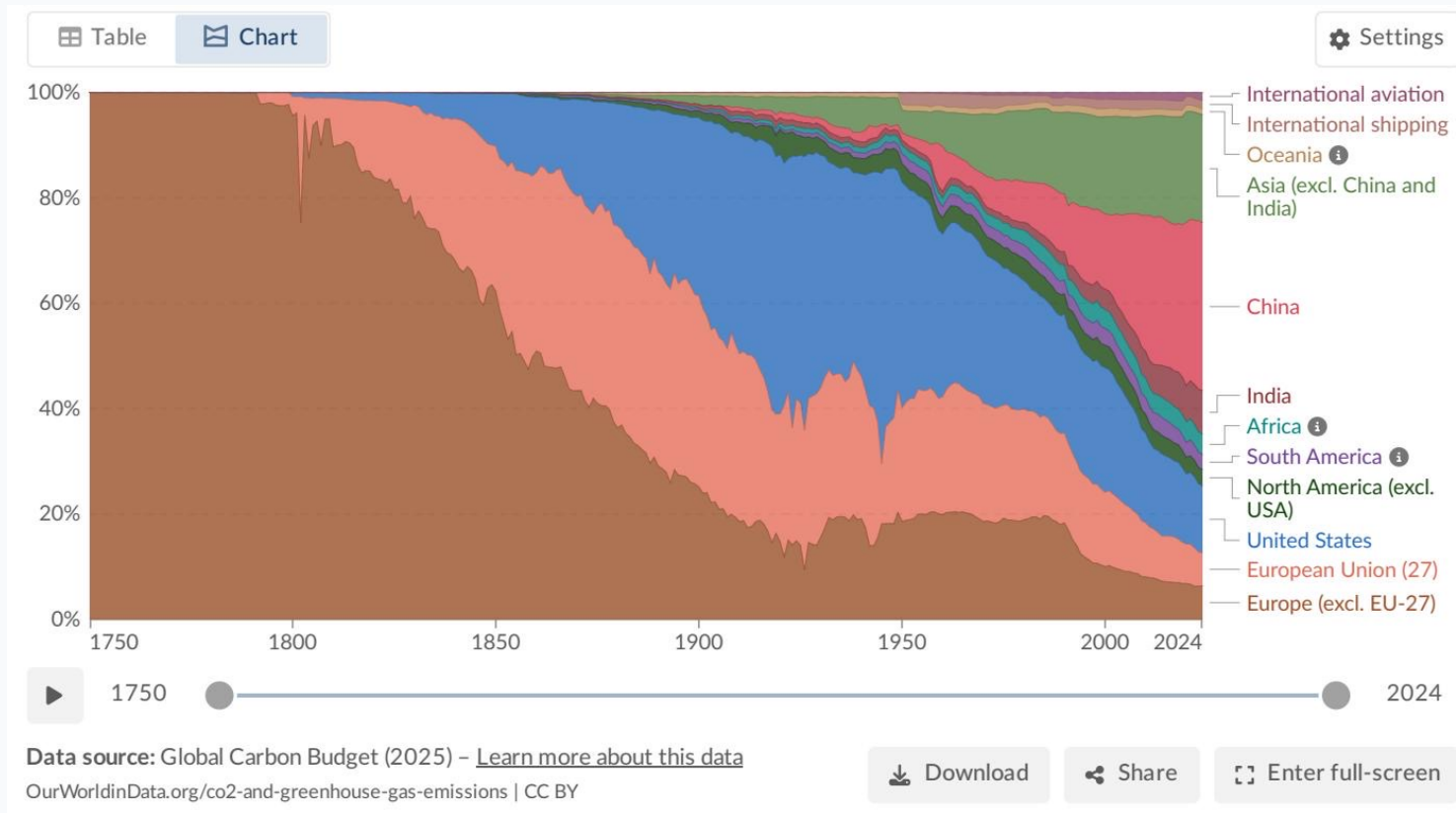
Evolution context



- US and Canada are roughly three times the global average.
- China remains below the US despite leading in total emissions.
- India is ~2 t/person; Kenya is ~0.4 t/person.

2024 Snapshot: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia and Africa C

Annual percentage change in CO₂ emissions shows a mixed picture of declines and increases.

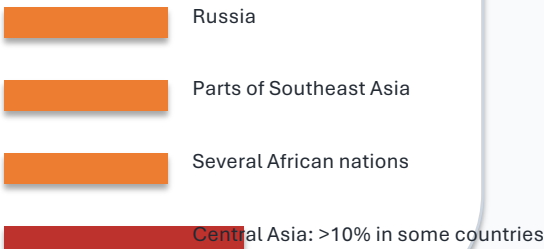


Diverging signals

Declines



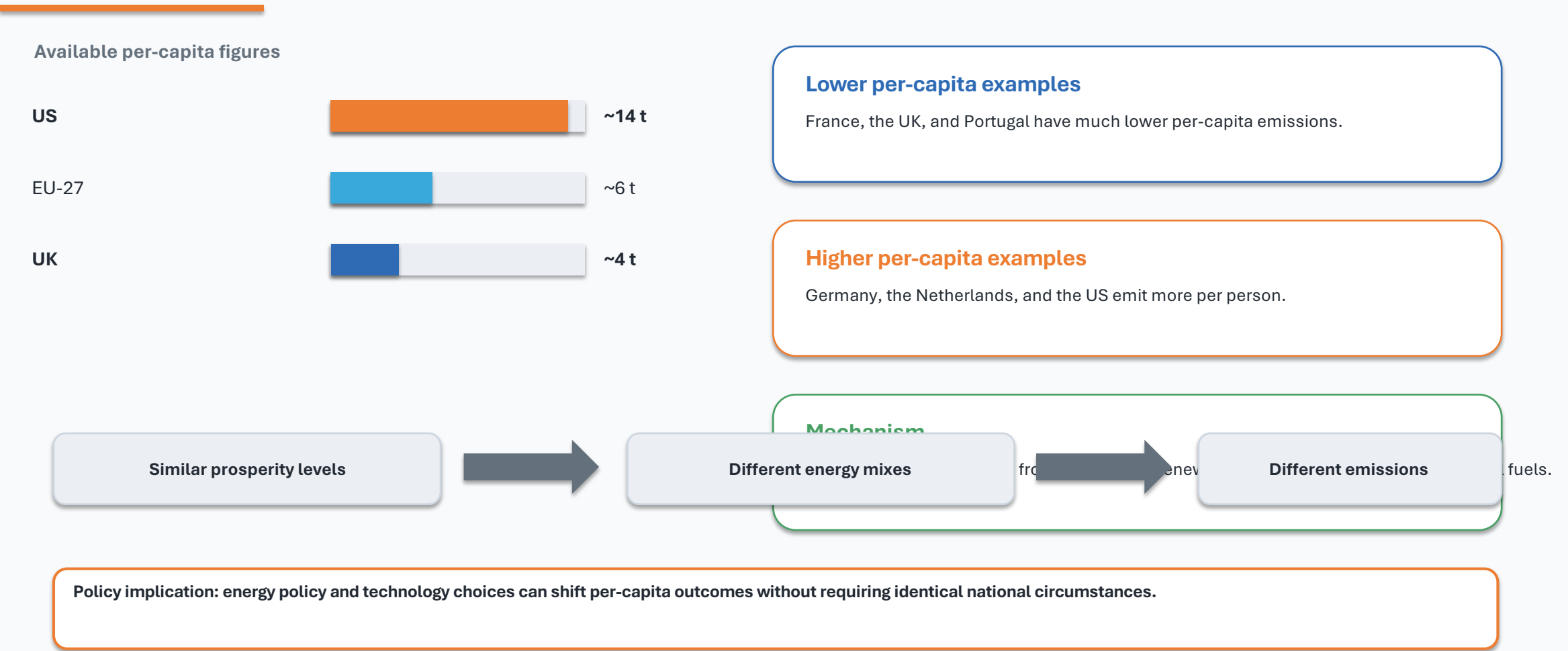
Increases



Blue = countries with declines; orange/red = countries with increases, matching the map

Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than Germany o

Among wealthy nations, energy choices can decouple prosperity from per-capita emissions.



Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

The data point to simultaneous imperatives: rapid global mitigation, historically informed responsibility, and development-sensitive equity.

No peak yet

Global fossil-fuel CO₂ exceeds 35 Bt/yr and has not yet peaked.

Annual dominance shifted

China is the largest annual emitter; Europe and the US now account for less than one-third.

Per-capita responsibility differs

China remains below the US per person; India remains very low at ~2 t.

Inequality persists

A roughly 150x gap separates the lowest emitters from the highest large-country emitters.

Energy policy matters

Technology and energy-mix choices can decouple prosperity from emissions.

Negotiation frame: shared global action, unequal historical and per-capita responsibility, and practical pathways through cleaner energy systems.